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Policy engine for governing cloud environments

Abstract

Embodiments govern cloud environments using a policy engine. A plurality of policy definitions for governing a plurality of managed environments can be received at a policy engine, each policy definition including one or more conditions and one or more actions, where the managed environments implement cloud based virtual machines that host cloud based applications. Events that relate to one or more of the managed environments can be received at the policy engine. Conditions for the policy definitions can be evaluated by the policy engine, where conditions for a first policy definition are triggered based on one or more of the received events. Based on the evaluating, one or more actions of the first policy definition can be performed, the one or more actions changing a first managed environment that is governed by the first policy definition.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/391,488, entitled POLICY ENGINE FOR GOVERNING CLOUD ENVIRONMENTS, filed Aug. 2, 2021, which claims priority to IN Patent Application No. 202141012524, filed Mar. 23, 2021, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference.

FIELD

(1) The embodiments of the present disclosure generally relate to governing cloud environments using a policy engine.

BACKGROUND

(2) The rapid rise of cloud computing has generated substantial value, but also presented new challenges. For example, cloud computing environments have increased the accessibility and flexibility of computing resources, however these environments themselves require management. Improperly managed environments can operate inefficiently, expose sensitive systems to cybersecurity risks, and otherwise ineffectively distribute computing resources. Accordingly, techniques for cloud environment governance can achieve improved system performance.

SUMMARY

(3) The embodiments of the present disclosure are generally directed to systems and methods for governing cloud environments using a policy engine. A plurality of policy definitions for governing a plurality of managed environments can be received at a policy engine, each policy definition

including one or more conditions and one or more actions, where the managed environments implement cloud based virtual machines that host cloud based applications. Events that relate to one or more of the managed environments can be received at the policy engine. Conditions for the policy definitions can be evaluated by the policy engine, where conditions for a first policy definition are triggered based on one or more of the received events. Based on the evaluating, one or more actions of the first policy definition can be performed, the one or more actions changing a first managed environment that is governed by the first policy definition.

(4) Features and advantages of the embodiments are set forth in the description which follows, or will be apparent from the description, or may be learned by practice of the disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Further embodiments, details, advantages, and modifications will become apparent from the following detailed description of the preferred embodiments, which is to be taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a system for governing cloud environments using a policy engine according to an example embodiment.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of a computing device operatively coupled to a prediction system according to an example embodiment.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates framework for governing cloud environments using a policy engine according to an example embodiment.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates a cloud manager according to an example embodiment.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates sample functionality for governing cloud environments according to an example embodiment.

(7) FIGS. 6-7 illustrate sequence diagrams for governing cloud environments according to an example embodiment.

(8) FIG. 8A illustrates a policy expression module according to an example embodiment.

(9) FIG. 8B illustrates a parse tree according to an example embodiment

(10) FIGS. 9-10 illustrate policy objects according to an example embodiment.

(11) FIG. 11 illustrates a policy action object according to an example embodiment.

(12) FIGS. 12A-12C illustrate user interfaces for governing cloud environments according to an example embodiment.

(13) FIG. 13 illustrates a flowchart for governing cloud environments using a policy engine according to an example embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(14) Embodiments govern managed computing environments using a policy engine. An environment can include computing environment (e.g., cloud computing environment) with a set of resources for administration (e.g., cloud applications, cloud computing resources, virtual machines, and the like). A policy can be a simplified technique for administering and automating different use cases (e.g., environments and other factors) using rules. For example, an environment can be managed using a policy by defining certain rules that, when satisfied, trigger certain actions.

(15) Embodiments of software, such as PeopleSoft, permit cloud administrators to manage different environments. For example, a common use case where policies can play a role is administering life cycle activities of environments. In some embodiments, policies can be scheduled or can be executed in real-time based on events. For example, scheduling allows policies to be executed at a set date and time or in a recurring fashion, such as: "Perform backup of all environments every Friday at 10 PM". In some embodiments, policies can also be triggered through internal or external events. An example policy that can make use of internal events is: "Perform update on all running

environments, when a new Infra DPK is downloaded". In some embodiments, policies can also be connected with external events, such as "Oracle Cloud Infrastructure" events or events generated from artificial intelligence ("AI")/machine learning ("ML") engines.

(16) In some embodiments, a policy engine can be configured to govern a plurality of computing environments. For example, various policies can be defined that each include conditions (e.g., for triggering the policy) and at least one action. In some embodiments, the policy engine can evaluate the conditions for the defined policies over time. For example, the conditions can be evaluated until one or more policies are triggered (e.g., when the conditions for the policies are met). In some embodiments, an external event can trigger a policy at the policy engine. Once triggered, the policy engine can execute one or more actions to manage an environment based on the triggered policy or policies.

(17) Reference will now be made in detail to the embodiments of the present disclosure, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. In the following detailed description, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the present disclosure. However, it will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that the present disclosure may be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known methods, procedures, components, and circuits have not been described in detail so as not to unnecessarily obscure aspects of the embodiments. Wherever possible, like reference numbers will be used for like elements.

(18) FIG. 1 illustrates a system for governing cloud environments using a policy engine according to an example embodiment. System **100** includes policy engine **102**, policy editor **104**, conditions **106**, and target actions **108**.

(19) Embodiments of the policy engine **102** can perform the following functions: Validating and converting policies defined using a policy editor to policy expressions using policy grammar specifications and storing those policy expressions (e.g., in a database). Connecting policies with process scheduler scheduling mechanisms. Connecting policies with internal and external events. Managing security constraints for the policies. Executing policy expressions.

(20) In some embodiments, policies are created and managed through policy editor **104**. For example, policy editor **104** can abstract the complexities of defining and managing policies, such as by providing a simplified user interface. Conditions **106** can include the conditions for triggering a policy (e.g., as defined using the policy editor). Target actions **108** can include the one or more actions to take when a policy has been triggered. For example, policy editor **104** can be used to define target action(s) for a policy.

(21) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a computer server/system **210** in accordance with embodiments. As shown in FIG. 2, system **210** may include a bus device **212** and/or other communication mechanism(s) configured to communicate information between the various components of system **210**, such as processor **222** and memory **214**. In addition, communication device **220** may enable connectivity between processor **222** and other devices by encoding data to be sent from processor **222** to another device over a network (not shown) and decoding data received from another system over the network for processor **222**.

(22) For example, communication device **220** may include a network interface card that is configured to provide wireless network communications. A variety of wireless communication techniques may be used including infrared, radio, Bluetooth®, Wi-Fi, and/or cellular communications. Alternatively, communication device **220** may be configured to provide wired network connection(s), such as an Ethernet connection.

(23) Processor **222** may include one or more general or specific purpose processors to perform computation and control functions of system **210**. Processor **222** may include a single integrated circuit, such as a micro-processing device, or may include multiple integrated circuit devices and/or circuit boards working in cooperation to accomplish the functions of processor **222**. In addition, processor **222** may execute computer programs, such as operating system **215**, policy engine **216**,

and other applications **218**, stored within memory **214**.

(24) System **210** may include memory **214** for storing information and instructions for execution by processor **222**. Memory **214** may contain various components for retrieving, presenting, modifying, and storing data. For example, memory **214** may store software modules that provide functionality when executed by processor **222**. The modules may include an operating system **215** that provides operating system functionality for system **210**. The modules can include an operating system **215**, policy engine **216**, as well as other applications modules **218**. Operating system **215** provides operating system functionality for system **210**. Policy engine **216** may provide system functionality for governing managed environments, or may further provide any other functionality of this disclosure. In some instances, policy engine **216** may be implemented as an in-memory configuration.

(25) Non-transitory memory **214** may include a variety of computer-readable medium that may be accessed by processor **222**. For example, memory **214** may include any combination of random access memory (“RAM”), dynamic RAM (“DRAM”), static RAM (“SRAM”), read only memory (“ROM”), flash memory, cache memory, and/or any other type of non-transitory computer-readable medium.

(26) Processor **222** is further coupled via bus **212** to a display **224**, such as a Liquid Crystal Display (“LCD”). A keyboard **226** and a cursor control device **228**, such as a computer mouse, are further coupled to communication device **212** to enable a user to interface with system **210**.

(27) In some embodiments, system **210** can be part of a larger system. Therefore, system **210** can include one or more additional functional modules **218** to include the additional functionality. Other applications modules **218** may include the various modules of Oracle® Cloud Infrastructure (“OCI”), Oracle® Cloud Infrastructure Data Science, Oracle® PeopleSoft, and Oracle® PeopleSoft Cloud Manger, for example. A database **217** is coupled to bus **212** to provide centralized storage for modules **216** and **218**. Database **217** can store data in an integrated collection of logically-related records or files. Database **217** can be an operational database, an analytical database, a data warehouse, a distributed database, an end-user database, an external database, a navigational database, an in-memory database, a document-oriented database, a real-time database, a relational database, an object-oriented database, Hadoop Distributed File System (“HDFS”), or any other database known in the art.

(28) Although shown as a single system, the functionality of system **210** may be implemented as a distributed system. For example, memory **214** and processor **222** may be distributed across multiple different computers that collectively represent system **210**. In one embodiment, system **210** may be part of a device (e.g., smartphone, tablet, computer, etc.).

(29) In an embodiment, system **210** may be separate from the device, and may remotely provide the described functionality for the device. Further, one or more components of system **210** may not be included. For example, for functionality as a user or consumer device, system **210** may be a smartphone or other wireless device that includes a processor, memory, and a display, does not include one or more of the other components shown in FIG. 2, and includes additional components not shown in FIG. 2.

(30) Conventional software does not readily permit defining policies for administering and automating different use cases, such as managing life cycle activities of environments in the cloud (e.g., managed environments). Consider an example use case-A cloud administrator would like to schedule backup of all environments. To achieve this in conventional systems, a cloud administrator may have to implement code (e.g., PeopleCode in an AE program) with software logic, such as logic to call an API's for performing the backup, then create a recurrence definition through process scheduler and associate code (e.g., the AE program) with the recurrence definition. This workflow includes unnecessary effort and requires unnecessary human expertise. Several other use cases are also relevant to such a cloud administrator (e.g., Scheduling refresh, start/stop of environments, and the like). Writing custom code and maintaining this code for many different

use cases can cause operational issues, and even eventually turn the entire system to an unmanageable state. Further, conventional systems do not include in-built mechanisms that permit a cloud administrator to connect policies through events.

(31) Embodiments implement a policy driven governance framework that simplifies the way cloud administrators (or users) can define policies to administer different use cases. For example, policies can be defined and managed through a user interface. Embodiments of the framework provide out of the box support for scheduling policies as well as connecting policies with internal and external events. For example, cloud administrators can define and expose custom objects through PeopleCode and add policies for those objects.

(32) In some embodiments, a policy has two parts—conditions and actions. Consider an example use case—a cloud administrator would like to schedule backup of all environments every Friday at 10 PM. From this a condition and policy action can be interpreted: condition—Execute the policy at 10 PM every Friday; action—Backup all environments. Embodiments of a policy can have multiple conditions which are connected (e.g., logically using logical operators (AND/OR)), and one or more actions (or a single action to limit ambiguities). In some embodiments, the policy editor abstracts the complexities of defining and managing the policies.

(33) FIG. 3 illustrates framework for governing cloud environments using a policy engine according to an example embodiment. System **300** of FIG. 3 includes cloud administrator **302**, policy editor **304**, policies **306**, events **308**, security and constraints **310**, condition evaluator **312**, cloud manager **314**, artificial intelligence (“AI”)/machine learning engine (“ML”) engine **316**, repository **318**, cloud **320**, managed environments **322**, and data science cloud **324**. In some embodiments, cloud administrator **302** (or any user adequate security) can use policy editor **304** to define policies **306**. For example, the defined policies **306** can each have one or more conditions and one or more actions.

(34) In some embodiments, security and constraints **310** can secure policy creation/editing based on permissions. For example, policies set by certain users (e.g., cloud administrator **302**) can have a global scope, meaning those policies are enforceable globally (e.g., across numerous managed environments). In some embodiments, other users can define policies on the environments that are associated with the user. For example, a user policy can be enforced on the environments associated with that specific user. Embodiments of security and constraints **310** can be used to set scope for policies, which can allow greater control on the functioning of the system.

(35) In some embodiments, events **308** (e.g., internal events within a managed environment or external events) can trigger conditions of defined policies **306**. For example, condition evaluator **312** can monitor events **308** and evaluate whether conditions for one or more defined policies **306** have been met. In some embodiments, the policy driven governance framework has built-in eventing mechanisms using push notification (PN) events. For example, policies can be executed in real-time as a result of occurrence of certain events **308**.

(36) In some embodiments, events **308** can be internal (triggered from within the system) or can be external (triggered from outside). Examples for internal event triggers are a download of new software (e.g., PeopleTools infra DPK) or application update image, detecting an anomaly within the domains of an environment (e.g., through a machine learning model), and the like. In some embodiments, these events can be used to trigger defined policies **306** and defined actions like updating CPU patches on the environments (e.g., when a new infra DPK becomes available) or executing autoscaling rules on the environment where the anomaly is detected.

(37) In some embodiments, policies **306** can also be triggered by external events. Example use cases include support for Oracle Cloud Interface Events. For example, OCI events can be triggered when a state change occurs on the resources comprising the provisioned environments. Such OCI events can be plugged into embodiments of the policy framework so that actions can be performed on them.

(38) In some embodiments, scheduling service **314** can trigger conditions of defined policies **306**,

for example based on defined policies **316** with timing conditions. Embodiments of the policy driven governance framework can have in-built support for scheduling policies through scheduling service **314**. Examples use cases include scheduling policy actions such as environment start/stop, backup, refresh, scale up, scale down, and the like. For example, a policy can be scheduled ad hoc (e.g., scheduled at a date and time) or can be connected to a process scheduler recurrence so as to execute the policy in a periodic fashion. A user (e.g., cloud administrator **302**) can schedule a policy based on exposed features (e.g., by the PeopleTools process scheduling service **314**).

(39) In some embodiments, cloud **320** can host managed environments **322**. The actions defined in policies **306** can be performed on the managed environments **322** when defined conditions are triggered. For example, a cloud manager application programming interface (“API”) can be used to perform these actions at cloud **320**/on the managed environments **322**.

(40) In some embodiments, data science cloud **324** can host AI/ML engine **316**. In some embodiments, AI/ML engine **316** can detect anomaly conditions, such as load conditions that deviate from normal conditions. In some embodiments, a machine learning model can be configured to monitor load for managed environments and predict anomaly conditions. When an anomaly condition is predicted, an event (e.g., events **308**) can be triggered (e.g., push notification for an event), which the policy engine can process (e.g., compare to defined policies to trigger policy actions).

(41) In some embodiments, anomaly detection is performed by embodiments of the cloud manager, where real-time data is collected and predicted by AI/ML engine **316**. For example, AI/ML engine **316** can make external application programming interface (“API”) calls (e.g., REST API calls) to data science cloud **324** for prediction. When a positive anomaly is detected, AI/ML engine **316** can transmit an internal notification (e.g., an internal event).

(42) In some embodiments, subscribers to this event (e.g., policies that cover environments with conditions based on this event) can have policy actions performed, such as scale-up or scale-down. PeopleSoft cloud manager has an Elastic Search node, which can collect metrics from managed environments in defined intervals. In some embodiments, real-time performance data from running the managed environments can be collected and stored, such as in object storage. For example, these metrics indicate the load on the application server domains, process scheduler domains, and Pure Internet Architecture (“PIA”) domains running on those managed environments. Data science cloud **324** can read the performance data, train one or more models and publish these models (e.g., within data science cloud **324**). After a model is published, real-time data fragments can be sent to prediction endpoints to detect user spikes or anomalies. When an anomaly condition is detected by AI/ML engine **316**, an internal event is raised.

(43) For example, to deploy AI/ML anomaly detection, the following can be performed. An administrator can deploy a distributed PeopleSoft environment (e.g., in the cloud). The administrator can then define/deploy a scaling policy for the managed environment. Performance data can be collected from distributed services running on multiple VMs/containers (e.g., for the managed environment). Machine learning model(s) that predict anomalies, user spikes, and/or user drips can be trained and published. Performance snapshots (e.g., performance data over a window of time) can be sent to/accessible by the trained model(s) to detect an anomaly. On detection of an anomaly, it is determined whether scaling up or scaling down condition(s) are met (e.g., introspect to see if the trend is linear, filtering out intermittent spikes and false positives). When a scaling up or scaling down condition is met, the scaling up or down of services (e.g., cloud computing resources) can be automatically performed.

(44) In some embodiments, defined policies can include conditions to automatically accept recommendations from the AI/ML engine **316** once an anomaly is detected. For example, anomaly detection can be used to scale the hardware used to implement the managed environments covered by defined policies. The hardware can include machines of various operating conditions that can implement a heterogenous computing environment (e.g., mix of linux and windows machines that

operation various cloud based applications). In some embodiments, the policy actions triggered by an anomaly detection can include scale up or scale down for one or more managed environments. For example, managed environments can include a number of implemented virtual machines/servers (e.g., hardware nodes) in various domains (e.g., e.g., application domain server, process scheduler domain, Pure Internet Architecture (“PIA”) domain). In some embodiments, the scale up/scale down policy action can include parameters such as the number of nodes to scale, the domains to scale (e.g., application domain server, process scheduler domain, PIA domain), and the like.

(45) FIG. 4 illustrates a cloud manager according to an example embodiment. System **400** includes administrator **402**, user groups **404**, cloud manager interface **406**, policies **408**, policy engine **410**, and managed environments **412**. In some embodiments, administrator **402** and/or user groups **404** can interact with cloud manager interface **406** to define policies **408**. For example, the defined policies **408** can include conditions and actions. In some embodiments, user groups **404** can define policies **408** with a local scope, such as policies that govern managed environments **412** related to the user group that defined/created the policy. For example, user groups **404** may be granted privileges to govern certain of managed environments **412**. In some embodiments, administrator **402** can define policies **408** with a local scope (e.g., limited to a subset of managed environments **412**) or a global scope (e.g., impacts all of managed environments **412**).

(46) In some embodiments, policy engine **410** can trigger one or more defined policies **408** based on a defined schedule and/or can monitor conditions (e.g., internal or external events) to detect when one or more defined policies **408** have been triggered. Some actions that can be implemented by policy engine **410** to govern managed environments **412** based on a triggered policy include autoscaling cloud resources up or down, starting/stopping a managed environment, backing up a managed environment, and the like.

(47) FIG. 5 illustrates sample functionality for governing cloud environments according to an example embodiment. In some embodiments, when policies are triggered for execution, policy scheduler handler **504** or policy event handler **506** can invoke the policy pre-processor **508**. For example, in case of scheduled policies, policy pre-processor **508** can retrieve from database **522**, the policy mapped with the schedule that became due and can invoke policy processor **514** to process the policy. In some embodiments, policy objects **510** are created and APIs are available for exposing/retrieving policy object artifacts **512**.

(48) In some embodiments, policy processor **514** is responsible for processing policy expression **516** and evaluating policy object artifacts **512** against policy expression **516**. Embodiments store policies added through the policy editor **502** in database **522** as a policy expression. An example below demonstrates a policy expression generated for a policy: Start environments with names HCMFT1 and HCMFT2. Note that this policy expression may be associated with some schedule, such as: IF ‘Environment’.‘Name’ In ‘HCMFT1’, ‘HCMFT2’ AND ‘Environment’.‘Status’ Is ‘stopped’ THEN ‘Environment’.‘Start’.

(49) In some embodiments, policy expressions are based on a pre-defined grammar, which means policy expressions comply with a syntax and semantics of the grammar. The following represents an example grammar in accordance with some embodiments. Each policy expression can have a structure, such as the example structure: IF <conditions> THEN <action>. In some embodiments, grammar for the policy expressions can be defined, and any suitable grammar can be used. For example, ANother Tool for Language Recognition (“ANTLR”) is a grammar builder and parser generator tool. Grammar represents the syntax and semantics of policy expressions and is composed of multiple rules. Thus, given a grammar, lexer and parser modules (e.g., java classes) can be generated from the grammar using the ANTLR tool. In some embodiments, rule expressions are generated using ANTRL based grammar specification. Implementations can use ANTLR java runtime binaries jar, for example as a third party library with a Cloud Manager deployment for generating/executing rule expressions.

(50) Below is a sample Policy Expression grammar. The rules in the grammar are expressed in top to bottom order.

(51) TABLE-US-00001 grammar PolicyGrammar; @header { package
com.peoplesoft.pa.cl.governance.policyengine.grammar; import java.util.ArrayList; } policy :
'IF' conditions 'THEN' action; conditions locals[ArrayList<PolicyElement> policyElements =
new ArrayList<PolicyElement>();]: c1=condition { \$policyElements.add(\$c1.ctx.conditionObj);
} (((('AND' { \$policyElements.add(new PolicyRelation(PolicyRelation.Relation.AND)); }
| 'OR' { \$policyElements.add(new PolicyRelation(PolicyRelation.Relation.OR)); }) ((' {
\$policyElements.add(new PolicyRelationGroup(PolicyRelationGroup.Group.START)); })?)
c2=condition { \$policyElements.add(\$c2.ctx.conditionObj); } ('' { \$policyElements.add(new
PolicyRelationGroup(PolicyRelationGroup.Group.END)); })*?)*; //(is used to indicate start of a
group and) for end of a group condition locals[PolicyCondition conditionObj = new
PolicyCondition();]: rule_variable[\$conditionObj]; rule_variable [PolicyCondition
conditionObj]: rule_entity ('Is' Value {
\$conditionObj.setConditionOperator(PolicyCondition.Conditionoperator.IS); } | 'In'
value_group { \$conditionObj.setConditionOperator(PolicyCondition.ConditionOperator.IN); });
rule_entity: feature_entity; feature_entity: Value '.' Value; value_group locals
[ArrayList<String> values = new ArrayList<String>();]: v1=Value { \$values.add(\$v1.getText(
) .toLowerCase()); } ('.' v2=Value { \$values.add(\$v2.getText() .toLowerCase()); })*; action:
feature_entity; IS : 'Is'; IN : 'In'; Value: '\' String ((WS | '.') String)* '\'; String: [A-Za-
z0-9_-]+; WS : [\t\r\n]+ -> skip;

(52) In some embodiments, ANTLR can generate source code (e.g., java code) files from the grammar specification. For example, generated lexer and parser modules along with the ANTLR run-time can perform parts of the processing for policy expressions. FIG. 8A illustrates a policy expression module according to an example embodiment. A policy expression **802** can be processed by ANTRL runtime **804**. For example, lexer **806** and parser **808** can be generated based on a grammar specification. The policy expression **802** is expected to comply with this grammar specification in order for the ANTRL runtime to process the expression.

(53) In some embodiments, lexer **806** can be a class responsible for deconstructing the input policy expression as a set of tokens. In some embodiments, parser **808** can be a class that contains logic for parsing the policy expression based on the grammar rules such that parse tree **812** is generated. For example, lexer **806** can feed tokens to parser **808** to construct a parse tree **812**.

(54) In some embodiments, a context class for each rule defined in the grammar can be generated. Listener **810** can be generated listener classes that contains logic to implement callbacks while navigating parse tree **812**. For example, objects for the rule context classes can be generated through the listener. In some embodiments, an ANTLR 4 runtime jar can be present in a CLASSPATH while executing policy expressions.

(55) In some embodiments, a walk of parse tree **812** can be performed to construct rule context objects using a listener **810**. Returning to FIG. 5, policy object artifacts **512** that are fed to policy processor **514** can be used as input to evaluate policy expression **516**, for example using listener **810** and rule context objects. Parse tree **512** of FIG. 5 can be generated in a manner similar to parse tree **812** of FIG. 8A.

(56) FIG. 8B illustrates a parse tree according to an example embodiment. Parse tree **820** is a parse tree of the following example policy expression according to some embodiments: IF 'Environment'.Name In 'HCMFT1', 'HCMFT2' AND 'Environment'.Status Is 'stopped' THEN 'Environment'.Start

(57) In some embodiments, policy evaluator **520** is responsible for evaluating policy expressions **516**. For example, policy object artifacts **512** (e.g., JavaScript Object Notation ("JSON") objects) can be retrieved by policy processor **514** from the policy object associated with the policy expression (e.g., stored at database **522**). In some embodiments, policy evaluator **510** can use

policy object artifacts **512** to evaluate policy expression **516**. In some embodiments, evaluation of policy expression **516** can include comparing the data contained in policy object artifacts **512** with the data contained in the rule context objects (e.g., the data that is part of the policy expression). For example, if policy evaluator **520** evaluates the policy conditions as TRUE, then a corresponding action for the policy can be executed.

(58) In some embodiments, comparing policy object artifacts **512** with the data contained in the rule context objects includes comparing the metadata in policy object artifacts **512** against the rule elements defined in the policy conditions. For example, policy object artifacts **512** can represent input to execute the policy. In some embodiments, each policy artifact object is a JSON object (set of key-value pairs). For example, a policy artifact for the Environment policy object has the following JSON structure, that has the environment name and the environment status.

(59) TABLE-US-00002 { “name”: “HCMDemo”, “status”: “Running” }

(60) In this example, the policy conditions has rule elements defined using the properties exposed by the Environment policy object (e.g., name and status). In some embodiments, the metadata in policy object artifacts **512** is compared with the rule elements in the policy conditions during evaluation of the policy expression, for example by parsing the policy expression tree.

(61) FIGS. **6-7** illustrate sequence diagrams for governing cloud environments according to an example embodiment. Sequence **600** of FIG. **6** demonstrates a sample sequence of activities with a policy scheduler that occur from the point where a policy is defined until execution according to some embodiments. For example, policy editor **602** can be used to define a policy, and the policy can be validated by policy engine **606** and stored at database **604**. Process scheduler **610** can invoke policy engine **608** when the schedule associated with the policy becomes due, and policy engine **608** can retrieve the policy from database **604**. Policy engine **608** can then evaluate the policy, and if the policy conditions are met, execute the one or more policy actions.

(62) Sequence **700** of FIG. **7** demonstrates a sample sequence of activities based on events that occur from the point where a policy is defined until execution according to some embodiments. In some embodiments, for policies based on events, policy engine **708** can subscribe for push notification (PN) events. For example, policy editor **702** can be used to define a policy, and the policy can be validated by policy engine **706** and stored at database **704**. Policy engine **708** can then subscribe for push notification events from application server runtime **712**.

(63) Application server runtime **712** can observe or experience an event, an event payload can be sent to event handler **710**, and event handler **710** can invoke policy engine **708**. Policy engine **708** can retrieve the policy from database **704**. In some embodiments, when a PN event occurs on the system, application server runtime **712** can propagate the event to event handler **710** (e.g., a PeopleCode application class). For example, embodiments of event handler **710** invoke policy engine **708**, which can read the policy from database **704** and execute them. Policy engine **708** can evaluate the policy, and if the policy conditions are met, execute the one or more policy actions.

(64) In some embodiments, an event (e.g., push notification received about an event) can trigger a scheduled action. For example, a download manager can be used to automatically download patches or updates relevant to different managed environments (e.g., patches for cloud applications that run in the managed cloud environments). A repository artifact policy object (e.g., an object related to downloaded patches/updates) can be defined/created with conditions that correspond to various downloaded patches or updates (e.g., platform, product, release, and the like). When the downloaded patch or update meets the policy conditions, the corresponding defined policy action can be a scheduled time to execute the patch or update, such as a day of the week and time of day (e.g., Sunday at 2:00 pm) so that updates/patches can be made at low activity times. In some embodiments, the defined/created policy object can cover multiple managed environments. In other words, once policy conditions are met by an event (e.g., push notification about a downloaded patch/update) the policy action can be executed for multiple managed environments (e.g., which are also defined in the policy conditions).

(65) In some embodiments, a policy expression can be constructed using a policy object. Consider the following example policy expression: IF 'Environment'.Name In 'HCMFT1', 'HCMFT2' AND 'Environment'.Status Is 'stopped' THEN 'Environment'.Start. The conditions and action portions of this example policy expression can be constructed using the policy object "Environment". For example, a policy object can represent a functional entity (in this example, a CM environment type is represented as a policy object) and can expose its properties and methods. In some embodiments, policy expressions can be constructed using the properties and methods exposed by these policy objects. In this example 'Name' and 'Status' are properties of the 'Environment' policy object while 'Start' is a method of the policy object. In some embodiments, the condition part of a policy expression comprises properties, while the action part comprises a method. For example, the method specified in the action part can be invoked by the policy engine if the conditions are evaluated as 'True'.

(66) In some embodiments, custom policy objects can be defined using an interface (e.g., PeopleCode) and those custom policy objects can be used to construct policies through Policy Editor. The following table lists example properties and methods exposed by inbuilt policy objects according to some embodiments.

(67) TABLE-US-00003 Policy Sample Sample Object Type Class Properties Methods Envi- Builtin EnvironmentPolicy Name: Start ronment Object Name of Stop Environment Status: Status of the environment (ex: Running, Stopped) Re- Builtin RepositoryArtifact Type: Update pository PolicyObject Type of the Envi- Artifacts downloaded artifact ronment Platform: OS platform of the downloaded artifact Product: Product the downloaded artifact belongs to Release: Product Release the downloaded artifact belongs to

(68) In some embodiments, the policy objects are used in the policy editor UI, so that policies can be created using those objects. For example, a Policy object class can implement the example methods getProperties() and getMethods() to expose metadata of the properties and methods it contains. In some embodiments, while processing scheduled policies, policy engine can retrieve the policy object artifacts so that those artifacts can be fed to the policy processor as input while processing policy expressions. For example, policy processor can take each policy object artifact and evaluate the policy expression using that artifact. A policy object class can implement the method getPolicyObjects() to expose policy object artifacts for scheduled policies.

(69) In some embodiments, for passing a policy object artifact to policy engine for execution, as a result of an event, the policy object class can implement the method getPolicyObject(JSONObject eventPayload). For example, policy engine can invoke this method of the policy object passing the event payload and expect, in return, the policy object artifacts for the policy processor (e.g., for feeding the policy processor, as input, while processing policy expressions).

(70) In some embodiments, the policy engine can execute a policy action when the policy conditions are evaluated to true. In the case of the following example policy expression, the policy engine can create an instance of the 'Environment' policy object and then invoke the method 'start' on the policy object: IF 'Environment'.Name In 'HCMFT1', 'HCMFT2' AND 'Environment'.Status Is 'stopped' THEN 'Environment'.Start

(71) In some embodiments, the logic for each policy action can be implemented in a separate class. For example, each policy action class can expose a JSON object representing the properties needed for executing the policy action logic. This allows policy processor to invoke different policy actions by passing the set of properties for those policy action objects. An example action where this will be useful is provisioning a new environment, which requires several pieces of input data. In some embodiments, this data can be passed as properties to the corresponding action object.

(72) In some embodiments, a process scheduler process ECL_POL_SCHD. ECL_POL_SCHD (e.g., an AE program) can be implemented that can be scheduled when a policy is activated (e.g., if the policy is a scheduled policy). For example, users can define policies, where the schedule can be either ad hoc (e.g., fixed date and time) or recurring (associated with a process scheduler recurrence

definition). In some embodiments, a unique “run control id” can be generated each time a policy is scheduled. This run control id can be associated with the instance of the AE program (ECL_POL_SCHD), that is responsible for the schedule. In some embodiments, when the schedule becomes due, the process ECL_POL_SCHD can be executed, which can internally trigger policy engine to execute the policy associated with the run control id. For example, this way adding or changing schedules for a policy any number of times will not adversely affect the policy execution. (73) In some embodiments, policies are also connected with events using Push Notification (PN) eventing mechanism. For example, policies can be triggered when a PN event occurs. Example use case is “Performing an environment update, when a new Infra DPK is downloaded in CM”. In some embodiments, a PN event definition named CM_POLICY_EVENT. CM_POLICY_EVENT can have the following example structure.

(74) TABLE-US-00004

Key Name	Description	Type	Name of the policy object class for which the event is intended for
KEY1	Key on which custom data can be passed	KEY2	Key on which custom data can be passed
KEY3	Key on which custom data can be passed	KEY4	Key on which custom data can be passed

...

(75) For example, the PN event CM_POLICY_EVENT can be subscribed through PeopleCode using the following:

(76) TABLE-US-00005

```
Local object &EventObject;
&EventObject = CreateObject("PSEvent");
&EventObject.Subscribe("CM_POLICY_EVENT", "ECL_CM:Governance: PolicyEventHandler:OnEvent");
```

(77) In some embodiments, the PeopleCode application class ECL_CM:Governance:PolicyEventHandler can act as an event handler component for the CM_POLICY_EVENT event. When a CM_POLICY_EVENT event is raised from an application server runtime, “OnEvent” method ECL_CM:Governance:PolicyEventHandler can be invoked with the event payload. In some embodiments, the application class can create an instance of the policy object using the metadata in the event payload and invoke the policy engine to process the policies associated with that policy object.

(78) FIGS. 9-10 illustrate policy objects according to an example embodiment. Class diagram 900 of FIG. 9 illustrates an example java class hierarchy for policy objects. For example, concrete policy object classes can expose properties and methods for the functionality they represent. A policy object class can implement the ‘PolicyObject’ interface.

(79) In some embodiments, the policy objects implemented can be extensible and a user can create custom policy objects. For example, users can define policies using those custom policy objects to meet custom requirements. In some embodiments, a policy object class can expose one or more properties. The ‘getProperties’ method in the policy object class can return a JSON object containing an array of properties. For example, each object in the array can be a JSON object containing the keys: name, description and values. The following shows the example property ‘Status’ for the ‘Environment’ policy object. The “values” array can be kept empty if the property does not expect a predefined value.

(80) TABLE-US-00006

Property Name	Value
“name”	“Status”
“description”	“Status of environment”
“values”	[“Running”, “Stopped”]

(81) In some embodiments, the ‘getMethods’ method can return a JSON object containing an array of methods exposed by the policy object. For example, each method in the JSON array can be a JSON object with the following keys: name and description. The following shows an example method.

(82) TABLE-US-00007

Method Name	Description
“name”	“Stop”
“description”	“Stops the environment”

3.3.1.3 Adding Support for Scheduled Policies

(83) In some embodiments, when a scheduled policy becomes due (e.g., is triggered based on meeting its conditions), policy processor can invoke the method ‘getPolicyObjects’ on the policy object class. For example, the ‘getPolicyObjects’ method can return an array of JSONObject's. Each JSONObject in the array can contain the properties and their values representing a single

policy object artifact. As an example, the policy object 'Environment' can contain the properties 'Name' and 'Status'. The 'getPolicyObjects' method can return the array of JSONObject's where each JSONObject can contain the property values representing a single 'Environment' policy artifact as shown below:

(84) TABLE-US-00008 { "Name": "HCMPUM", "Status": "Running" }

(85) In some embodiments, a policy object class can implement the method 'getPolicyObjects(JSONObject eventPayload)' in order to connect the policies with events. For example, when an event occurs, the policy engine can identify if it is related to a particular policy object. In that case the 'getPolicyObjects' of the policy object can be invoked by passing the event payload. This method can return an array of JSONObject's, each containing the property values of a single policy object.

(86) Class diagram **1000** of FIG. **10** illustrates a policy context object. For example, class diagram **1000** shows that embodiments of the policy processor can create and associate a PolicyContext object with each policy object while processing the policy expression. In some embodiments, while processing the policy expression, the Policy Processor can set the owner for the policy object instance (in case of the environment policy object, owner can be the user who created the environment) using the API provided by PolicyContext. In some embodiments, policy engine can use the owner details from the policy object and the policy definition to determine whether to execute a policy expression or not.

(87) FIG. **11** illustrates a policy action object according to an example embodiment. For example, class diagram **1100** illustrates a policy action object. In some embodiments, each policy action class can implement logic to perform the policy action it represents. The class can expose methods to get/set properties for performing the action.

(88) In some embodiments, a policy object class can implement the method 'executeMethod(methodName, JSONObject)'. For example, this method can be invoked by the policy engine, when the policy engine executes the corresponding policy action. In some embodiments, the properties for the policy action class can be passed as parameter to the 'executeMethod'. Example functionality for the environment stop action according to some embodiments is shown below.

(89) TABLE-US-00009 public class EnvironmentPolicyObject implements PolicyObject
{ public void executeMethod(String methodName, JSONObject propObj) {
switch(methodName) { case "Stop": stop(propObj);
break; case "Start": start(propObj); break;
default: break; } } protected void stop(JSONObject
actionPropObj) { PolicyAction envStopAction = new EnvironmentStopAction ();
envStopAction.setPropertyValues(actionPropObj); envStopAction.performAction (); } }

(90) FIGS. **12A-12C** illustrate user interfaces for governing cloud environments according to an example embodiment. Interface **1200** of FIG. **12A** can be used by administrator or users to define conditions and actions for a policy (e.g., a selected policy object). Interface **1200** includes policy group **1202**, policy type **1204**, policy object **1206**, conditions fields **1208**, policy action **1210**, policy schedule **1212**, and policy expression **1212**.

(91) In some embodiments, the policy group can be the group the policy belongs to (e.g., selected using a dropdown). The policy type can describe the type of policy (e.g., schedule, event, and the like). The policy object can be the object type for the policy (e.g., environment, repository artifact, a custom object created by a user, and the like). Based on the underlying object structure for the selected policy object, conditions field **1208** dynamically displays forms to input conditions (e.g., properties of the object type) that are relevant to the selected policy object (e.g., environment). For example, properties for the environment policy object can include name and status, and thus input forms for name and status can be dynamically displayed in conditions field **1208** (e.g., when the environment policy object is selected).

(92) Similarly, policy schedule **1212** can be dynamically displayed based on the policy type, which is schedule in interface **1200**. Policy schedule can be used to select a schedule for the policy. Policy expression **1214** dynamically displays the expression for the policy defined using the input forms of interface **1200**.

(93) Policy action **1210** can be used to define the action for the policy. Based on the policy object definitions, the drop down menu can be populated with the possible policy actions for the policy object. In interface **1200**, the selected policy action is backup (e.g., for the policy object environment). Policy actions can be based on the structure of the relevant policy object (e.g., Environment, Repository Artifact, Custom object, and the like). In some embodiments, the same set of policy actions can be triggered either through schedule policies or through event policies. In some embodiments, a similar set of policy actions can be triggered through schedule policies or through event policies, though these sets of policy actions may have some differences.

(94) Interface **1220** of FIG. **12B** similarly includes policy group **1202**, policy type **1204**, policy object **1206**, conditions fields **1208**, policy action **1210**, and policy expression **1214**. The policy type and object selected in interface **1220** are Event and Repository Artifact. Accordingly, conditions fields **1208** dynamically displays properties for the Repository Artifact policy object (e.g., Type, Tool Version, and any other suitable properties) as input forms to define conditions for the policy being defined.

(95) Similarly, policy action **1210** can have the drop down menu populated with the possible policy actions for the Repository Artifact policy object. Policy schedule **1212** of interface **1200** is not displayed in interface **1220** because the selected policy type in interface **1220** is “Event”, which does not take a schedule in its definition. Policy expression **1214** dynamically displays the expression for the policy defined using the input forms of interface **1220**.

(96) Interface **1230** of FIG. **12C** similarly includes policy group **1202**, policy type **1204**, policy object **1206**, conditions fields **1208**, policy action **1210**, and policy expression **1214**. The policy type and object selected in interface **1230** are Event and Autoscale. Conditions fields **1208** dynamically displays properties for the Autoscale policy object (e.g., Domain Type, Mode, and any other suitable properties) as input forms to define conditions for the policy being defined.

(97) Similarly, policy action **1210** can have the drop down menu populated with the possible policy actions for the Auto scale policy object/Event policy type (e.g., ScaleUpAppDomain). Policy schedule **1212** of interface **1200** is not displayed in interface **1230** because the selected policy type in interface **1230** is “Event”, which does not take a schedule in its definition. Policy expression **1214** dynamically displays the expression for the policy defined using the input forms of interface **1230**.

(98) In some embodiments, because a user can define custom policy objects (e.g., by using the disclosed interface and exposing the relevant properties/methods) the user interface for governing cloud environments is extensible. In other words, once a custom policy object (with defined parameters/conditions and methods/actions) is created by a user, interfaces **1200**, **1220**, and/or **1230** can be configured such that policies can be defined and implemented using the custom policy object. This can include dynamically displaying/populating the relevant web forms (e.g., drop down menus, input forms) given the custom policy object structure.

(99) FIG. **13** illustrates a flowchart for governing cloud environments using a policy engine according to an example embodiment. In one embodiment, the functionality of FIG. **13** is implemented by software stored in memory or other computer-readable or tangible medium, and executed by a processor. In other embodiments, each functionality may be performed by hardware (e.g., through the use of an application specific integrated circuit (“ASIC”), a programmable gate array (“PGA”), a field programmable gate array (“FPGA”), etc.), or any combination of hardware and software.

(100) At **1302**, a plurality of policy definitions for governing a plurality of managed environments are received at a policy engine, each policy definition including one or more conditions and one or

more actions. In some embodiments, the managed environments implement cloud based virtual machines that host cloud based applications.

(101) In some embodiments, each defined policy belongs to one of a predetermined set of policy objects. For example, the received policy definitions are defined by a user through a user interface, and when a policy object is selected using a first input form of the user interface, additional input forms are dynamically displayed on the user interface or dynamically populated based on a structure of the selected policy object. In some embodiments, each policy object structure includes policy object properties that are used to define conditions for a policy that belongs to the policy object.

(102) At **1304**, events that relate to one or more of the managed environments can be received at the policy engine. In some embodiments, the policy engine can subscribe to an application server for event push notifications.

(103) At **1306**, conditions for the policy definitions can be evaluated by the policy engine, where conditions for a first policy definition are triggered based on one or more of the received events. In some embodiments, the one or more received events that triggered the conditions for the first policy are events external to the first managed environment. For example, the events can be received from an AI/ML engine.

(104) In some embodiments, evaluating conditions for the policy definitions includes evaluating policy expressions that represent the conditions of the policy definitions. For example, a policy grammar can be predefined such that the received policy definitions comply with the policy grammar, and runtime objects can be generated based on the predefined policy grammar. In some embodiments, the runtime objects can be used to evaluate the policy expressions by generating a parse tree for the policy expressions.

(105) At **1308**, based on the evaluating, one or more actions of the first policy definition can be performed, the one or more actions changing a first managed environment that is governed by the first policy definition. In some embodiments, the one or more actions of the first policy definition include one or more of starting the first managed environment, stopping the first managed environment, updating the first managed environment, backing up the first managed environment, scaling up cloud resources for the first managed environment, and scaling down cloud resources for the first managed environment

(106) Embodiments govern managed computing environments using a policy engine. An environment can include computing environment (e.g., cloud computing environment) with a set of resources for administration (e.g., cloud applications, cloud computing resources, virtual machines, and the like). A policy can be a simplified technique for administering and automating different use cases (e.g., environments and other factors) using rules. For example, an environment can be managed using a policy by defining certain rules that, when satisfied, trigger certain actions.

(107) Embodiments of software, such as PeopleSoft, permit cloud administrators to manage different environments. For example, a common use case where policies can play a role is administering life cycle activities of environments. In some embodiments, policies can be scheduled or can be executed in real-time based on events. For example, scheduling allows policies to be executed at a set date and time or in a recurring fashion, such as: “Perform backup of all environments every Friday at 10 PM”. In some embodiments, policies can also be triggered through internal or external events. An example policy that can make use of internal events is: “Perform update on all running environments, when a new Infra DPK is downloaded”. In some embodiments, policies can also be connected with external events, such as “Oracle Cloud Infrastructure” events or events generated from artificial intelligence (“AI”)/machine learning (“ML”) engines.

(108) In some embodiments, a policy engine can be configured to govern a plurality of computing environments. For example, various policies can be defined that each include conditions (e.g., for triggering the policy) and at least one action. In some embodiments, the policy engine can evaluate

the conditions for the defined policies over time. For example, the conditions can be evaluated until one or more policies are triggered (e.g., when the conditions for the policies are met). In some embodiments, an external event can trigger a policy at the policy engine. Once triggered, the policy engine can execute one or more actions to manage an environment based on the triggered policy or policies.

(109) The features, structures, or characteristics of the disclosure described throughout this specification may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments. For example, the usage of “one embodiment,” “some embodiments,” “certain embodiment,” “certain embodiments,” or other similar language, throughout this specification refers to the fact that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment may be included in at least one embodiment of the present disclosure. Thus, appearances of the phrases “one embodiment,” “some embodiments,” “a certain embodiment,” “certain embodiments,” or other similar language, throughout this specification do not necessarily all refer to the same group of embodiments, and the described features, structures, or characteristics may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments.

(110) One having ordinary skill in the art will readily understand that the embodiments as discussed above may be practiced with steps in a different order, and/or with elements in configurations that are different than those which are disclosed. Therefore, although this disclosure considers the outlined embodiments, it would be apparent to those of skill in the art that certain modifications, variations, and alternative constructions would be apparent, while remaining within the spirit and scope of this disclosure. In order to determine the metes and bounds of the disclosure, therefore, reference should be made to the appended claims.

Claims

1. A method for governing cloud environments using a policy engine, the method comprising: receiving, at a policy engine, a plurality of policy expressions for governing a plurality of managed environments, each policy expression comprising one or more conditions and one or more actions, wherein the managed environments implement cloud based virtual machines that host cloud based applications, and the policy expressions are processed to generate policy expression data structures for evaluating the policy expressions; receiving, at the policy engine, one or more events that relate to one or more of the managed environments, wherein events payloads are received corresponding to the one or more events; retrieving, by the policy engine, one or more policy objects associated with the one or more events, wherein retrieving at least a portion of the one or more policy objects comprises creating instances of the portion of policy objects based on event payloads from at least a portion of the one or more received events; evaluating, by the policy engine, the conditions for the policy expressions using the policy expression data structures and the retrieved policy objects, wherein, conditions for a first policy expression are triggered based on one or more of the received events, and the conditions for the first policy expression are evaluated using one or more of the portion of retrieved policy objects; and performing, based on the evaluating, one or more actions of the first policy expression, the one or more actions changing a first managed environment that is governed by the first policy expression, wherein the one or more actions of the first policy expression are performed via invoking at least one of the retrieved policy objects.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the one or more received events comprise predefined event structures, and the one or more policy objects retrieved are associated with the one or more received events based on the predefined event structures.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein at least one policy object comprises an operating status information about one or more of the managed environments.
4. The method of claim 3, wherein the policy engine compares one or more conditions from the policy expression data structure that corresponds to the first policy expression to the operating

status information from the one or more policy objects to determine that the conditions for the first policy expression are triggered by the one or more of the received events.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the policy expressions are structured according to a predefined grammar.

6. The method of claim 5, wherein one or more runtime objects, generated according to a structure of the predefined grammar, are used to process the policy expressions and generate the policy expression data structures.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the one or more actions of the first policy expression comprise one or more of starting the first managed environment, stopping the first managed environment, updating the first managed environment, backing up the first managed environment, scaling up cloud resources for the first managed environment, and scaling down cloud resources for the first managed environment.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein the policy expression data structures comprise parse trees generated based on the policy expressions.

9. The method of claim 3, wherein the operating status information about one or more of the managed environments is accessed by retrieving one or more properties of the at least one policy object.

10. The method of claim 9, wherein the one or more properties of the at least one policy object are retrieved via invoking a method of the at least one policy object.

11. The method of claim 1, wherein invoking at least one of the retrieved policy objects to perform the one or more actions comprises invoking a method of the at least one retrieved policy objects.

12. A system for governing cloud environments using a policy engine, the system comprising: a processor; and a memory storing instructions for execution by the processor, the instructions configuring the processor to: receive, at a policy engine, a plurality of policy expressions for governing a plurality of managed environments, each policy expression comprising one or more conditions and one or more actions, wherein the managed environments implement cloud based virtual machines that host cloud based applications, and the policy expressions are processed to generate policy expression data structures for evaluating the policy expressions; receive, at the policy engine, one or more events that relate to one or more of the managed environments, wherein events payloads are received corresponding to the one or more events; retrieve, by the policy engine, one or more policy objects associated with the one or more events, wherein at least a portion of the one or more policy objects are retrieved by creating instances of the portion of policy objects based on event payloads from at least a portion of the one or more received events; evaluate, by the policy engine, the conditions for the policy expressions using the policy expression data structures and the retrieved policy objects, wherein conditions for a first policy expression are triggered based on one or more of the received events, and the conditions for the first policy expression are evaluated using one or more of the portion of retrieved policy objects; and perform, based on the evaluating, one or more actions of the first policy expression, the one or more actions changing a first managed environment that is governed by the first policy expression, wherein the one or more actions of the first policy expression are performed via invoking at least one of the retrieved policy objects.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the one or more received events comprise predefined event structures, and the one or more policy objects retrieved are associated with the one or more received events based on the predefined event structures.

14. The system of claim 12, wherein at least one policy object comprises an operating status information about one or more of the managed environments.

15. The system of claim 14, wherein the policy engine compares one or more conditions from the policy expression data structure that corresponds to the first policy expression to the operating status information from the one or more policy objects to determine that the conditions for the first policy expression are triggered by the one or more of the received events.

16. The system of claim 12, wherein the policy expressions are structured according to a predefined grammar.
17. The system of claim 16, wherein one or more runtime objects, generated according to a structure of the predefined grammar, are used to process the policy expressions and generate the policy expression data structures.
18. The system of claim 12, wherein the one or more actions of the first policy expression comprise one or more of starting the first managed environment, stopping the first managed environment, updating the first managed environment, backing up the first managed environment, scaling up cloud resources for the first managed environment, and scaling down cloud resources for the first managed environment.
19. The system of claim 12, wherein the policy expression data structures comprise parse trees generated based on the policy expressions.
20. A non-transitory computer readable medium having instructions stored thereon that, when executed by a processor, cause the processor to govern cloud environments using a policy engine, wherein, when executed, the instructions cause the processor to: receive, at a policy engine, a plurality of policy expressions for governing a plurality of managed environments, each policy expression comprising one or more conditions and one or more actions, wherein the managed environments implement cloud based virtual machines that host cloud based applications, and the policy expressions are processed to generate policy expression data structures for evaluating the policy expressions; receive, at the policy engine, one or more events that relate to one or more of the managed environments, wherein events payloads are received corresponding to the one or more events; retrieve, by the policy engine, one or more policy objects associated with the one or more events, wherein at least a portion of the one or more policy objects are retrieved by creating instances of the portion of policy objects based on event payloads from at least a portion of the one or more received events; evaluate, by the policy engine, the conditions for the policy expressions using the policy expression data structures and the retrieved policy objects, wherein conditions for a first policy expression are triggered based on one or more of the received events, and the conditions for the first policy expression are evaluated using one or more of the portion of retrieved policy objects; and perform, based on the evaluating, one or more actions of the first policy expression, the one or more actions changing a first managed environment that is governed by the first policy expression, wherein the one or more actions of the first policy expression are performed via invoking at least one of the retrieved policy objects.
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